

The C++ Programming Language

The C++ Programming Language is a computer programming book first published on October 14, 1985.^[1] It was the first book to describe the C++ programming language, written by the language's creator, Bjarne Stroustrup. In the absence of an official standard, the book served for several years as the *de facto* documentation for the evolving C++ language, until the release of the *ISO/IEC 14882:1998: Programming Language C++* standard on 1 September 1998. As the standard further evolved with the standardization of language and library extensions and with the publication of technical corrigenda, later editions of the book were updated to incorporate the new changes.

History

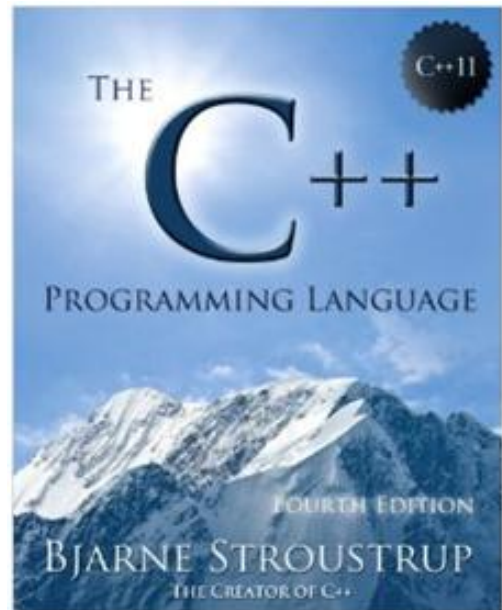
The first edition of *The C++ Programming Language* was published in 1985. As C++ evolved, a second edition was published in July 1991, reflecting the changes made.

The third edition of the book was first published on 30 June 1997; a hardcover version of the third edition, with two new appendices, was later published as *The C++ Programming Language: Special Edition* on 11 February 2000. Both the softcover third edition and the hardcover “special edition” have since undergone several reprintings, with corrections.^[3]

C++ Solutions (ISBN 0-201-30965-3) is a companion book to the third edition of *The C++ Programming Language*. It contains solutions to selected exercises of *The C++ Programming Language*.

The fourth edition of the book, which incorporates C++11, was released on May 19, 2013.^[4]

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Cover of the fourth edition.

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See also

- *The C Programming Language*
- List of computer science journals and List of software programming journals
- List of computer books

References

1. Calore, Michael (2010-10-14). "Oct. 14, 1985: C++ Adds to Programming | This Day in Tech | WIRED" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20140422005418/https://www.wired.com/2010/10/1014cplusplus-released/>). *WIRED*. Archived from the original (<https://www.wired.com/2010/10/1014cplusplus-released/>) on 2014-04-22. Retrieved 2025-09-13. "Oct. 14, 1985: C++ Adds to Programming **1985**: The first official reference guide for the C++ programming language is published. The author, Bjarne Stroustrup, is also the language's creator"
2. Stroustrup, Bjarne (2013-05-12). "Books by Bjarne Stroustrup" (<http://www.stroustrup.com/books.html>). *Bjarne Stroustrup's homepage*.
3. Stroustrup, Bjarne (2004-09-08). "The C++ Programming Language (Third Edition and Special Edition)" (<http://www.stroustrup.com/3rd.html>). *Bjarne Stroustrup's homepage*.
4. Stroustrup, Bjarne (2012-12-09). *The C++ Programming Language* (Fourth ed.). ISBN 978-0321563842.

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